

Sea Shanties



A songbook prepared by
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WARNING

These shanties are a product of their time,
some may represent regressive views.

This shanty songbook strives to ride the line between
authentic but also not problematic. We did our best.



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All For Me Grog

CHORUS

C All for me grog, me jolly jolly grog **F**

C All for me beer and tobacco **G**

C For I spent all me tin down on South Street drinkin gin **F**

C And across the western ocean I must wander **G7 C**

Where are me boots, me noggin', noggin' boots,
They're all gone for beer and tobacco
For the heels they are worn out and the toes are kicked about
And the soles are looking out for better weather.

CHORUS

Where is me shirt, me noggin' noggin' shirt
All gone for beer and tobacco
For the collar is wore out and the front is knocked about
And the tail is looking out for better weather

CHORUS

I'm sick in the head and I haven't been to bed,
Since first I came ashore from me slumber,
For I spent all me dough on me ladies don't you know
Far across the western ocean I must wander

CHORUS

Barrett's Privateers

Stan Rogers, 1976

C **G**
Oh, the year was seventeen seventy-eight

C
How I wish I was in Sherbrooke now!

C **F** **G**
A letter of marque came from the king

C **G**
To the scummiest vessel I've ever seen

C
God damn them all!

CHORUS

C **F** **G**
I was told we'd cruise the seas for American gold

F **C**
We'd fire no guns, shed no tears

C **F**
Now I'm a broken man on a Halifax pier

Dm **G** **C**
The last of Barrett's privateers

On the ninety-sixth day we sailed again

How I wish I was in Sherbrooke now!

When a bloody great Yankee hove in sight

With our cracked four-pounders we made to fight

God damn them all!

CHORUS

Then at length we stood two cables away

How I wish I was in Sherbrooke now!

Our cracked four-pounders made an awful din

But with one fat ball the Yank stove us in

God damn them all!

CHORUS

The Antelope shook and pitched on her side

How I wish I was in Sherbrooke now!

Barrett was smashed like a bowl of eggs

And the main-truck carried off both me legs

God damn them all!

CHORUS

So here I lay in me twenty-third year

How I wish I was in Sherbrooke now!

It's been six long years since we sailed away

And I just made Halifax yesterday

God damn them all!

CHORUS

Bully Boys

CHORUS

^C And it's row me bully boys ^F we're in a hurry boys

^C we've got a long way to go ^{G7}

^C And we'll sing and we'll dance and bid farewell to France ^F

^{G7} row me bully boys ^C row

And we sailed away in the roughest of water,

row me bully boys row

But now we return in the most royal quarters,

row me bully boys row

CHORUS

See, now, how we feast on pheasants by a flock,

row me bully boys row

It's a long, long way from the gruel and the stocks,

row me bully boys row

CHORUS

A wee dram of whiskey for every man,

row me bully boys row

And a barrel of rum for the shanty man,

row me bully boys row

CHORUS

And we sailed away in the roughest of water,

row me bully boys row

And now we return and so lock up your daughters,

row me bully boys row

CHORUS

Bully in the Alley

Sally is the girl that I love dearly,

way hey bully in the alley

Sally is the girl that I spliced nearly,

bully down in shinbone al—

CHORUS

G

So help me ba ba bully in the alley,

C

G

D

way hey bully in the alley

G

So help me ba ba bully in the alley,

C

G

D

bully down in shinbone al—

Seven long years I've courted Sally

way hey bully in the alley

All she did was dilly and dally,

bully down in shinbone al—

CHORUS

Sally Brown I took a notion

way hey bully in the alley

To sail across this wide damn ocean,

bully down in shin-bone al—

CHORUS

Well I'll leave Sal and I'll go sailin'

way hey bully in the alley

Leave my gal and I'll go whalin',

bully down in shinbone al—

CHORUS

Drunken Sailor

What will we do with a drunken sailor?

What will we do with a drunken sailor?

What will we do with a drunken sailor?

Early in the morning!

CHORUS

Dm

Way hey and up she rises

C

Way hey and up she rises

Dm

Way hey and up she rises

F C Dm
Early in the morning!

Shave his belly with a rusty razor

Shave his belly with a rusty razor

Shave his belly with a rusty razor

Early in the morning!

CHORUS

Put him in a long boat till he's sober

Put him in a long boat till he's sober

Put him in a long boat till he's sober

Early in the morning!

CHORUS

Stick him in a scupper with a hose-pipe on 'im

Stick him in a scupper with a hose-pipe on 'im

Stick him in a scupper with a hose-pipe on 'im

Early in the morning!

CHORUS

That's what we do with a drunken sailor

That's what we do with a drunken sailor

That's what we do with a drunken sailor

Early in the morning!

Health to the Company

Kind friends and companions, come join me in rhyme

Come lift up your voices in chorus with mine

Come lift up your voices all grief to refrain

For we may or might never all meet here again

CHORUS

Am **Em** **G** **Am**
Here's a health to the company and one to my lass

Am **C** **Am** **G**
Let us drink and be merry all out of one glass

Am **C** **Am** **G**
Let us drink and be merry all grief to refrain

Am **Em** **G** **Am**
For we may or might never all meet here again

Here's a health to the dear lass that I love so well

For her style and her beauty, sure none can excel

There's a smile on her countenance as she sits on my knee

There's no man in this wide world as happy as me

CHORUS

Our ship lies at anchor, she's ready to dock

I wish her safe landing, without any shock

If ever I should meet you by land or by sea

I will always remember your kindness to me

CHORUS

Joli Rouge

The Dreadnoughts, 2019

From France we get the Brandy, from Martinique the rum
Sweet red Cabernet from Italy does come
But the fairest of them all, me boys, the one to beat the day
...is made from apples up the mighty Saguenay.

CHORUS

Dm **Am**
So follow me lads... cause this ain't no grog or ale

Dm **C**
One pint down you'll be swinging in the gale

Dm **C** **F**
Five pints bully you'll be shaking in your shoes

Dm **C7** **Dm**
...We're half-seas over on the Joli Rouge.

She's called the Dreadnought Cider, she's proper and she's fine
And when the day is over sure I wish that she were mine
Or in the dark of winter, or on a summer's eve
...One hand giveth and the other does receive.

CHORUS

So turn your sails over and bring her hard to port
Find that little star and fly straight into the North
The wild sun upon your back the wind a-blowing free
...You're rolling up the river boys to old Chicoutimi.

CHORUS

So you can have a Magners and pour it over ice
Or you can have a Strongbow if it's sadness that you like
Or join us up the river and we'll set your heart aglow
...And how you'll feel when the real cider starts to flow.

CHORUS

Leave Her Johnny

CHORUS

G **C**
Leave her Johnny leave her

F **C**
Oh leave her Johnny leave her

F **C** **G** **C**
For the voyage is long and the winds don't blow

C **G7** **C**
And it's time for us to leave her

I thought I heard the old man say

Leave her Johnny leave her

Tomorrow ye will get yer pay

And it's time for us to leave her

CHORUS

Oh the wind was foul and the sea was high

Leave her Johnny leave her

She shipped it green and none went by

And it's time for us to leave her

CHORUS

I hate to sail on this rotten tub

Leave her Johnny leave her

No grog allowed and rotten grub

And it's time for us to leave her

CHORUS

We swear by rote for want of more

Leave her Johnny leave her

But now we're through so we'll go on shore

And it's time for us to leave her

CHORUS

Mingulay Boat Song

CHORUS

D **G**
Heave her ho, boys, let her go, boys

D C

Swing her head round into the weather

D **G**
Heave her ho, boys, let her go, boys

D G
Sailing homeward to Mingulay

What care we, though, white the Minch is?

What care we, boys, for windy weather

When we know that every inch is

Sailing homeward to Mingulay

CHORUS

Wives are waiting by the pier head

Gazing seaward from the heather

Bring her round, boys, then we'll anchor

'Ere the sun sets on Mingulay

CHORUS

Ships return now, heavy laden

Mothers holdin' bairns a-cryin'

They'll return yet when the sun sets

Sailing homeward to Mingulay

CHORUS

Randy Dandy O

CHORUS

E♭

Heave a pawl oh heave a way

B♭

Way hey roll and go

E♭

The anchor's on board and the cable's all stored

B♭

E♭

C♯

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

Now we are ready to sail for the Horn

Way hey roll and go

Our boots an' our clothes, boys, are all in the pawn

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

CHORUS

Man the stout caps'n and heave with a will

Way hey roll and go

For soon we'll be drivin' away up the hill

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

CHORUS

Heave away, bullies, ye parish rigged bums

Way hey roll and go

Take your hands from your pockets and don't suck your thumbs

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

CHORUS

We're outward bound for Vallipo Bay

Way hey roll and go

Get crackin', me lads, it's a hell of a way!

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

CHORUS

Soon we'll be warping her out through the locks

Way hey roll and go

Where the pretty young girls all come down in their frocks

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

CHORUS

Come breast the bar bullies heave with a will

Way hey roll and go

Oh soon we'll be rolling her down through the bay

To me rollickin' randy dandy O

Roll the Old Chariot Along

We'd be all right if the wind was in our sails.

We'd be all right if the wind was in our sails.

We'd be all right if the wind was in our sails.

And we'll all hang on behind.

CHORUS

Dm

And we'll roll the old chariot along

C

We'll roll the old chariot along

Dm

We'll roll the old chariot along

F

C

Dm

And we'll all hang on behind

We'll be all right if we make it round The Horn.

We'll be all right if we make it round The Horn.

We'll be all right if we make it round The Horn.

And we'll all hang on behind.

CHORUS

Well a nice wash below wouldn't do us any harm.

Well a nice wash below wouldn't do us any harm.

Well a nice wash below wouldn't do us any harm.

And we'll all hang on behind.

CHORUS

Well a night on the town wouldn't do us any harm.

Well a night on the town wouldn't do us any harm.

Well a night on the town wouldn't do us any harm.

And we'll all hang on behind.

CHORUS

Oh a drop of Nelson's blood wouldn't do us any harm.

Oh a drop of Nelson's blood wouldn't do us any harm.

Oh a drop of Nelson's blood wouldn't do us any harm.

And we'll all hang on behind.

CHORUS

Skipper Jan Rebec

F **Bb** **F**
Who's the king of the fighting Dutch

F** **C** **F
Skipper Jan Rebec

F **Bb**
And who do the sailors fear so much

F** **C
Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

And it's

F** **Bb
Ja ja leave your hammocks

F** **C
*Ja ja *hands on deck**

F** **Bb
Ja ja break your backs for

F** **C** **F
Skipper Jan Rebec

And who brought all the tea from China

Skipper Jan Rebec

And sold it all in the Carolina

Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

And who can furl the main topsail

Skipper Jan Rebec

All his own in a living gale

Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

And who can drink his weight in beer

Skipper Jan Rebec

And only takes two baths a year

Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

Who sleeps with four folks every night

Skipper Jan Rebec

One up, one down, one left, one right

Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

So who's the king of the fighting Dutch

Skipper Jan Rebec

And who do the sailors fear so much

Skipper Jan Rebec

CHORUS

South Australia

E **A** **E**
In South Australia I was born

Heave away, haul away

E **B7** **E**
In South Australia 'round Cape Horn

B7 **E**
We're bound for South Australia

CHORUS

A **E**
Haul away, you rolling kings

A **E** **A** **E**
Heave away, haul away

A **E**
Haul away, oh hear me sing

B7 **E**
We're bound for South Australia

As I walked out one morning fair

Heave away, haul away

It's there I met Miss Nancy Blair

We're bound for South Australia

CHORUS

I shook her up, I shook her down

Heave away, haul away

I shook her round and round the town

We're bound for South Australia

CHORUS

There ain't but one thing grieves my mind

Heave away, haul away

To leave young Nancy Blair behind

We're bound for South Australia

CHORUS

I'm Bristol born and Bristol bred

Heave away, haul away

I'm thick in the arm and thick in the head

We're bound for South Australia

CHORUS

Wellerman

Cm

There once was a ship that put to sea,

the name of the ship was the Billy o Tea.

The winds blew hard, her bow dipped down.

Oh blow my bully boys blow.

CHORUS

Soon may the Wellerman come

to bring us sugar and tea and rum

One day the tonguin is done

we'll take our leave and go

She'd not been two weeks from shore,

when down on her a right whale bore.

The captain called all hands and swore

"We'll take that whale in tow".

CHORUS

Before the boat had hit the water,

the whale's tail came up and caught her.

All hands to the side, harpooned and fought her,

when she dived down below.

CHORUS

No line was cut, no whale was freed,

The captain's mind was not of greed.

But he belonged to the Whaleman's creed.

She took that ship in tow.

CHORUS

For forty days or even more,
The line went slack then tight once more.
All boats were lost, there were only four,
but still that whale did go.

CHORUS

As far as I've heard, the fight's still on
The line's not cut and the whale's not gone.
The Wellerman makes his regular call
To encourage the captain crew and all.

CHORUS

Whiskey Johnny

E

Whiskey is the life of man

Whiskey, Johnny!

D

A

I'll drink whiskey while I can

Whiskey for my Johnny Oh!

Oh whiskey straight and whiskey strong,

Whiskey, Johnny!

Give me some whiskey and I'll sing you a song

Whiskey for my Johnny Oh!

Here comes the cook with the whiskey can,

Whiskey, Johnny!

A glass of grog for every man.

Whiskey for my Johnny Oh!

A glass of grog for every man,

Whiskey, Johnny!

And a bottle full for the shantyman.

Whiskey for my Johnny Oh!
